

Barents
Sea

URAL MOUNTAINS

Forming a natural boundary between Europe and Asia, the Urals run from the Arctic Circle to the dry temperate steppes of Kazakhstan.

PLAINS AND PENINSULAS

Europe

Europe is the western portion of the supercontinent of Eurasia, separated from Asia by the Black and Caspian seas, and the Ural and Caucasus mountains. It is a geologically and ecologically complex continent, with ancient glaciated uplands to the north and west, a vast plain sweeping east from southern England to Russia, and central uplands preceding the steep rocky terrain of the Alps—the longest mountain chain in Europe.

Roughly half of the landmass comprises major peninsulas—Scandinavia, Jutland, Brittany, Iberia, Italy, and the Balkans—or large islands such as Great Britain, Ireland, and Iceland. The influence of the surrounding oceans and seas on climate is considerable.

Natural habitats and their plant and animal life occur in zones according to latitude. Tundra and coniferous forests dominate the north, giving way to deciduous forests, agricultural landscapes, mountains, and Mediterranean habitats in the south. Many species of bird and insect migrate annually between Asian breeding grounds and European wintering areas.

LIMESTONE CAVES



MANITA PEC CAVE

Karst landscapes, such as the Kras region of Slovenia and Italy, consist of thin, dry, alkaline soils above limestone bedrock with caves and underground rivers. Some are home to the cave salamander, or olm.



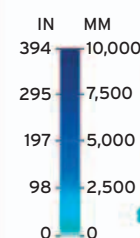
OLM

KEY DATA

ECOSYSTEMS

- Temperate broadleaf forest
- Temperate coniferous forest
- Desert, scrub
- Temperate grassland
- Mediterranean woodland, scrub
- Montane grassland
- Boreal forest/taiga
- Tundra
- Ice

AVERAGE RAINFALL



AVERAGE TEMPERATURE

